

UNIT
73

COMMUNICATION

CONVERSATION

Laura (Manager): Hey! It seems we haven't reached out to the client about the campaign draft yet, right?

Ryan: Not yet. I was going to run it by you first — just to make sure it's okay before I send it.

Laura: Alright. I wonder if you could keep everyone in the loop once it goes out, so no one's caught off guard.

Ryan: Sure thing!

Tina (Assistant): It seems like the design team's been waiting for that update. Do you want me to handle the follow-up, Ryan?

Ryan: Yeah, that'd be great.

Tina: Okay, then. I'll check it tomorrow morning and make sure they've replied.

Laura: It looks like we're all set then. To put it in a nutshell, we just need to send the draft, wait for feedback, and adjust if needed.

Ryan: Exactly. Then next week we can circle back, depending on what they say.

Laura: Great. I wonder if you could also clarify whether they still want the old color palette or the new one before sending.

Ryan: Yeah, I'll ask when I reach out, and I'll touch base with you afterward.

Laura: Alright, sounds good. It seems like everything is finally coming together. Thanks, both of you.



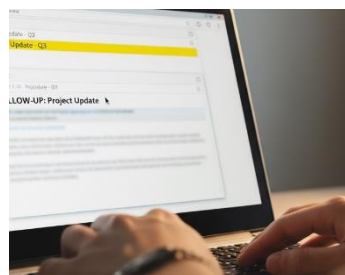
VOCABULARY



Reach out to



Run by



Follow-up

Keep in the
loop



Touch base



Put it in a
nutshell



Circle back



Clarify

LANGUAGE PRACTICE

Hedging patterns

No hedge

We haven't
reached out to
the client
about the
draft yet.



With hedge

It seems we
haven't
reached out to
the client about



We're all set;
everything is
ready to go.



It looks like
we're all set
and everything
is ready to go.



Can you keep
everyone in the
loop when you
send the draft?



I wonder if you
could keep
everyone in the
loop when you
send the draft?





COMMUNICATION

EXERCISE 1

Use each vocabulary word once to complete the sentences: reach out; run it by; keep in the loop; follow-up; touch base; put in a nutshell; circle back; clarify)

- A. Before I send this, I want to _____ you to make sure it's okay.
- B. We need to send a _____ e-mail tomorrow to check if anything changed.
- C. Let's _____ later today just to give a quick update.
- D. Please _____ the whole team _____ so nobody is surprised.
- E. I'll _____ to the client and see if they are available.
- F. We can _____ next week after we get more information.
- G. For the summary, just _____ the main points so it's easy to read.
- H. Can you _____ what the client really wants? I don't understand it quite well.

EXERCISE 2

Rewrite each sentence using a hedging pattern (*it seems / it looks like / I wonder if*).

- A. You didn't update the file.

- B. We need to fix this mistake now.

- C. Can you check the numbers again?

- D. You should email the client today.

- E. Nobody reviewed the draft yet.

- F. You're not following the instructions.

SUMMARY

Hedging Structure	Form / Pattern	Use / Purpose	Examples
It seems...	<i>It seems + clause</i>	To make a polite observation based on what you see or know.	It seems the file is missing. It seems you didn't get the update.
It looks like...	<i>It looks like + clause</i>		It looks like the draft isn't ready yet. It looks like we need more time.
I wonder if...	<i>I wonder if + subject + could/would + verb</i>	To make polite requests or questions without sounding demanding.	I wonder if you could check this again. I wonder if you could email the client.

EXERCISES ANSWER KEYS

Exercise 1

- A. run it by
- B. follow-up
- C. touch base
- D. keep the whole team in the loop
- E. reach out
- F. circle back
- G. put in a nutshell
- H. clarify

Exercise 2

- A. It seems / It looks like you didn't update the file.
- B. It looks like / It seems we need to fix this mistake.
- C. I wonder if you could check the numbers again.
- D. I wonder if you could email the client today.
- E. It seems / It looks like nobody reviewed the draft yet.
- F. It looks like / It seems you're not following the instructions.